



TRADING PORTS

Most of the world's coastal cities were built on wealth created by ocean trade. Many still have thriving ports, but most modern cargo ships dock at dedicated terminals equipped for dealing with particular types of freight. This port has special cranes designed for loading and unloading containers.



WOW!

The biggest cargo ship in the world, MSC Oscar, is more than the length of four football fields.



FLOATING HOTELS

Big, slow ocean liners were once the only way to travel between continents. Today, most people travel by air, which is much quicker, but passenger ships have become popular for cruise vacations. They are like giant floating hotels, which carry tourists in luxury to a series of exotic locations over a number of days.



PIRACY

Ocean trade is much safer than it used to be, thanks to accurate charting of coastal hazards and the development of electronic navigation systems. But in some parts of the world, ships still risk attack by heavily armed pirates in small speedboats. If attacked, this ship has fire hoses to stop pirates climbing aboard and seizing command.

